



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Classical Academy

School Website: <https://tcaomaha.com/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.*

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

Trinity Classical Academy (TCA) in Nebraska operates with a clearly classical Christian identity that is visible across its public materials. The school emphasizes formation of character through a Christian framework, a liberal-arts oriented curriculum, and a pedagogy that combines contemplative elements with Socratic-style discussion and rhetoric. The institution markets itself as a collaborative model that partners with parents as co-educators, integrates Great Books and liberal arts thinking, and presents a high level of intentional formation rather than narrow job-preparatory outcomes. Public statements stress that education is not value-neutral, that theology informs the curriculum, and that students are formed through virtue, philosophy, and the great conversation of Western civilization. The presence of "Christian education," a stated aim toward wisdom and virtue, and explicit calls for parental partnership align strongly with classical ideals as defined by the Six Essential Elements framework.

Overall classification: **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence from the school's public materials shows explicit religious grounding and the ordering of the soul toward truth, goodness, and beauty (Element 1).
- The school's stated purpose emphasizes formation, virtue, and contemplation rather than mere information or workforce readiness (Element 2).
- The curriculum is framed around liberal arts and Great Books concepts, with references to classical education resources and reading lists (Element 3).
- Pedagogical methods include rhetoric, reasoning, and a high school emphasis on persuasive expression (Element 4).
- Faculty/faculty leadership language implies a model of virtue and mentorship in the classroom (Element 5).
- Parental partnership and community formation with open engagement and joint formation of affections are foregrounded (Element 6).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials affirm Christian education as formative and doctrinally anchored: "Christian Education affirms the core doctrines of the Christian faith (the Apostles' Creed) and seeks to shape students in accordance with these truths." and "Education is not merely the transfer of information; it is the ordering of the soul's affections in accordance with some ultimate desire." - The school describes itself as Christian and connected to a theology-informed worldview, with explicit statements about shaping desires and forming love in line with Christian formation. - Resources for classical education on the site frame classical education in a

Christian context and provide access to foundational classical texts and readings (e.g., “Classical Education Reading & Resources” including The Lost Tools of Learning and What is Classical Education?).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (from the Six Elements lexicon): truth, virtue, wisdom, formation, sacred tradition/theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder, Logos, moral order, divine order, and the ordering of affections. Evidence of formation toward the good and the sacred is explicit in the site’s language. - Negative keywords: None evidenced in the public materials; there is no explicit shift to secularism or relativism in the provided content.

Why this rating - The site strongly anchors education in theology and moral formation, with explicit statements about Christian formation and the moral aims of education. This aligns with the Positive Keywords for Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded in Theology, and Liturgical/Community Practices, indicating CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL. The absence of negative signals in the public content supports this rating.

## **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation, virtue, and wisdom, not merely job-preparation. The school states: “Education is not value-neutral. All teaching is formative in nature,” and emphasizes “to raise wise, virtuous human beings who love and serve God.” - The school frames education as “formation, not information,” aiming at human flourishing and virtue, rather than simply preparing for work. - The Renaissance of the Great Conversation and Great Books framing is evident in resources that foreground classical inquiry and the Great Books as a central reference (e.g., links to classical education readings and resources).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/-good/beautiful (as transcendental aims in classical education), contemplation/scholé (through the restfulness implied by classical pedagogy). The site’s language evokes formation of character and moral imagination. - Negative keywords: Not present in the public materials (e.g., “workforce readiness,” “career-ready,” or value-neutral language).

Why this rating - The school’s stated goal centers on virtue formation and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, aligning with the classical aim of forming a person rather than merely transmitting information. The absence of a job-prep emphasis in the public descriptions supports CLASSICAL.

## **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The site promotes the Liberal Arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books, supported by explicit references to classical resources and the Great Conversation. The public materials point to classical education resources and the Great Books movement. - Public pages frame the curriculum within a liberal-arts context and emphasize that students study classical texts and engage in classical inquiry via the Great Books reading list and resources. - The site discusses the Liberal Arts, with references to formal scriptural and classical literacy resources and a classical approach to education (e.g., the “Liberal Arts” content and Reading & Resources).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources/original texts, classical canon, Western civilization, history as a connected discipline, wonder/integration of subjects. The site references these ideas and resources. - Negative keywords: No explicit emphasis on social studies substitution for history or purely project-based/experiential-only curriculum; the materials show classical content rather than anti-historical framing.

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly described through liberal-arts framing, Great Books resources, and a classical emphasis on the Trivium/Quadrivium and perennial texts, which matches the category’s Positive keyword indicators and supports CLASSICAL.

**Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school describes students in the Rhetoric Stage (high school) as being challenged to speak and write persuasively, with leadership in mind, which aligns with a rhetoric and Socratic/serious dialogue orientation. - The site references collaborative education and a structure that integrates both on-campus instruction and home-based work, involving parents as co-educators in a liturgical, contemplative framework. - The public materials emphasize the role of memory work, memorization/recitation, and formation through practice, consistent with classical pedagogy (Scholé and memory-based methods) and the integration of memorization with rhetoric.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, memorization/recitation, scholarly discussion, rhetoric, memory work, scholarship in an integrated/structured setting, scholé (restful learning), guided discussion, great conversation, and formation through imitation and practice. The site shows “Rhetoric Stage,” public podcast and speaker emphasis, and the language of “leadership” and persuasive expression. - Negative keywords: No strong signals of purely project-based, experiential-only, or constructivist-dominant pedagogy; rather, evidence supports a balanced classical pedagogy with memory work and Socratic-style discourse. Where present, collaborative/home-based models are framed as a supplement, not a replacement for classical teaching modes.

Why this rating - The pedagogy aligns with classical indicators (Socratic/dialogic inquiry, memorization, rhetoric and oratory, restfulness in learning, and formation through models), giving CLASSICAL.

**Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials emphasize faculty who model virtue and mentor students, and present teachers as part of a living curriculum; the school’s leadership language highlights a head of school and a culture of professional formation. - The materials describe collaboration and mentorship within the faculty (e.g., “collaborative education” and a culture of “living curriculum” through teachers who embody virtue and professional formation). - Commentary about the faculty’s role and expectations is aligned with classical expectations of teachers as virtuous exemplars and co-educators who guide students in the Great Conversation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtuous educators, mentor/teacher as exemplar, living curriculum, faculty collaboration, mentorship, collegiality, master-apprentice dynamics, character formation (as evidenced by the Christian formation language and leadership roles). - Negative keywords: No explicit signals of non-classical faculty models (e.g., solely certification-driven, facilitator-as-coach without classical content). The public materials emphasize character and mentorship, aligning with classical ideals.

Why this rating - The presence of virtue modeling, mentorship, a living curriculum concept, and a culture of faculty collaboration align with CLASSICAL criteria for the Faculty category.

**Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public statements frame parents as co-teachers and partners in classical education; the collaborative model is described as a shift that allows parents to lead in a structured environment. The school emphasizes parent partnership and formation of affections through classical education. - Materials enumerate parent formation and classical book studies, family involvement, and an open-campus approach to engagement; the school encourages families to participate in the school’s ethos and events. - The site includes explicit contact and engagement resources for families, and information on how to partner with the school in education (e.g., “parent partnership,” “co-teachers,” and “open campus”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, family involvement, home-school collaboration, parental engagement, and open campus. These map to the Positive Keywords under “Parents and Community” (Partnership with Families; Formation of Affections; Cultural Transmission). - Negative keywords: Not evident; material frames parent involvement as central rather than consumer-like engagement or hands-off involvement. The absence of “customer” or minimal involvement language aligns with CLASSICAL indicators.

Why this rating - The school explicitly promotes parent partnership and family involvement in a classical framework, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Assessment - The six categories collectively align with CLASSICAL indicators. The site's Christian grounding, formation-focused aims, liberal-arts/canonic curriculum, rhetoric/Socratic pedagogy, virtue-centered faculty ideals, and active parent partnership all align with the Six Essential Elements' Positive Keywords and framework.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - If the school seeks to further strengthen the CLASSICAL profile, minor enhancements could include explicit public statements about: - Great Books program and direct references to specific canonical authors in the curriculum per grade level. - Additional explicit mentions of memory work, scholé-inspired pacing in upper grades, and opportunities for formal classical recitation or chant in the lower grades. - A formal "living-curriculum" portrait or model language for teachers that mirrors the Aristotelian/-Platonian classical images. - Expanded parental education offerings (e.g., regular parent seminars tied to classical pedagogy and philosophy) to deepen the partnership with families.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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